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**NOVEMBER 2025 U/103/24-25/AT00101/
24-25/35105**

PAPER I – ENGLISH

Time : Three hours

Maximum : 100 marks

SECTION A — (10 × 2 = 20 marks)

Answer ALL the questions.

1. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) He is more taller than his brother.
 - (b) I can sings very well.
2. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) Neither of the students have finished their homework.
 - (b) She suggested me to join the meeting earlier.

3. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) He explained me the problem in detail.
 - (b) The teacher, along with her students, are going on a trip.
4. Fill in the blanks with suitable pronouns.
 - (a) This is my brother, _____ is very tall.
 - (b) The teacher asked Tom and me to stay after class. She wanted to talk to _____.
5. Write negative ends for the following sentences.
 - (a) I'm a teacher, but (at university)
 - (b) He is a boy, but (handsome)
6. Complete the following sentences with the correct tense of the verbs given in brackets:
 - (a) She _____ (watch) TV when I called her yesterday.
 - (b) By the time we arrived, they _____ (finish) dinner.
7. Give the synonyms of:
 - (a) Frightened
 - (b) Scared

8. Give the antonyms of:
- (a) Expand
 - (b) Optimistic
9. Use the word 'Vanished' in a meaningful sentence.
10. Use the Phrase 'Give-up' in a meaningful sentence.

SECTION B — ($5 \times 7 = 35$ marks)

Answer ALL the questions.

11. Read the following passage and answer the questions given.

The Elephant Whisperers, a 43-minute documentary walks us through the Theppakadu Elephant camp located near the Mudumalai Wildlife Sanctuary, in Nilgiris, Tamilnadu. The viewers are then introduced to the two elephant mahouts, Bomman and Bellie, who belong to indigenous Communities dwelling in the forests and whose families have been elephant care takers for generations. But the spotlight of the

documentary is on Raghu, a baby elephant, orphaned and badly-wounded after dogs bit and tore at him when he strayed away from the herd while they were in search of water. The Forest Department entrusted the seriously injured baby Raghu with Bomman and Bellie and from there we are made to witness the magical and unspeakable bonding between the duo and the elephant calf. Raghu is nursed back to good health, thanks to the dedicated efforts of the couple (Bomman and Bellie eventually get married as the film progresses) But Raghu turns out to be a pampered and spoilt baby, (just like a human child) and grows stubborn too.

He gets jealous when the couple have to give their attention to yet another elephant calf, Ammu, who comes under their foster care. Raghu is then assigned to another care taker as he has to be trained to be a survivor of the fittest in the harsh wildlife terrain The heart-broken Bomman and Bellie are unable to bear the pangs of separation but soon come to terms with their grief. One of the most astonishing and touching scenes in the footage is when Raghu with his

elephant trunk wipes Bellies tears away during one of her melancholic moments (one of the favourite scenes of the director Kartiki Gonsalves herself). When Kartiki met the 3-month-old Raghu for the first time enroute her hometown Ooty, she found him absolutely adorable and grew very attached to him Propelling her to make a film, with Raghu as its principal subject Her film captures beautiful moments of Raghu as an extremely intelligent and caring animal besides focusing its concentrated attention on indigenous communities and their earnest attempts towards forest conservation.

- (a) Where is the Theppakadu elephant sanctuary situated?
- (i) Mudumalai Wildlife Sanctuary, in Nilgiris, Tamilnadu
 - (ii) Periyar Wildlife Sanctuary — Kerala
 - (iii) Nagarhole Wildlife Sanctuary — Karnataka.
 - (iv) Indira Gandhi Wildlife Sanctuary Tamilnadu.

- (b) How did the elephant calf Raghu get hurt?
 - (i) caused by dogs and other animals attacking him.
 - (ii) due to extreme weather in the region.
 - (iii) Because of ill health
 - (iv) Due to separation.
- (c) Does the film focus on threats facing wildlife?
 - (i) Yes, film faces issues and threats.
 - (ii) No, the film does not mainly focus on threats facing wildlife.
 - (iii) Some hurdles
 - (iv) Completely blocked this film.
- (d) Describe how Bomman and Bellie nurtured the injured Raghu.
 - (i) Made to witness the magical and unspeakable bonding by caring.

- (ii) They were not looking properly
 - (iii) Made to punish
 - (iv) Never bothered about Raghu.
 - (e) What are the merits of this Oscar-winner documentary? (3)
12. Comment on the Picture given below: (7)

FLOODING DURING MONSOON

The picture below is an image we can all relate to-monsoon and flooding in the city. Write a paragraph narrating your memories of the 2023 Cyclone Michaung in Chennai and how it impacted you and your family.



13. (a) How does Emily Dickinson use imagery to portray the bird's behavior in the poem "*A Bird, came down the Walk*"? (7)

Or

- (b) How does Maathai link environmental conservation to peace and sustainable development in her speech? (7)
14. (a) What does the relationship between humans and elephants in the film teach us about harmony with nature? (7)

Or

- (b) Explain how Kamala Ramakrishnan uses contrast in the text — between natural and artificial flavours, familiar and exotic, etc.(7)
15. (a) Describe the, 'Great Mouse Plot' in *The Bicycle and the Sweet Shop*? (7)

Or

- (b) What are your responses to the manner in which Mr. Coombes thrashed young Dal with a cane? (7)

SECTION C — ($3 \times 15 = 45$ marks)

Answer the following in about 250 words.

16. Read the following news report and answer the questions.

News Reports.

Quarter of Moroccan graduates unemployed, report shows A quarter of university graduates in Morocco were jobless in 2023 - the highest unemployment rate for those who hold degrees in about two decades, according to a new report. The report was published by the Haut commission au Plan or the High Commission for Planning, during March. The commission does statistical analyses of social, demographic and economical data. According to the report, the 25.9% of unemployed university degree holders in 2023 is the highest in 18 years. This is almost twice the national unemployment average of 13% of the total number of unemployed individuals recorded at the end of 2023. Of all of those holding higher diplomas, 9.4% were jobless, an increase of 0.7 percentage points. Nearly seven

out of 10 individuals (71.2%) who had previously worked but exited the job market have a university degree. Dr Abdennasser Naji, the president of the Amaquen Institute, an education think tank in Morocco, told University World News: “This is an official report that sounds the alarm about the significant rise in unemployment in Morocco. especially among graduates of higher education institutions. It highlights the inability of the Moroccan economy to create enough jobs in a context in which there were a large number of job losses in the past two years.” After a loss of 24,000 jobs in 2022, Morocco’s economy lost another 157,000 positions in 2023, according to a February 2024 report by the High Commission for Planning titled, The state of the labour market in 2023. “Universities and the labour market share the responsibility for graduate unemployment” said Naji, who is also a former adviser to Morocco’s minister of higher education and scientific research. Whereas, the labour market has to be able to absorb the competencies produced by universities, universities are required to formulate education and training

courses that respond to the needs of the national economy, while improving graduates' ability to be entrepreneurial to contribute to the establishment of companies, Naji suggested. Expanding further, Professor Abdul Benahnia, an academic affairs and business development manager of the 3B Golden Gate E-learning platform in Morocco, told University World News that the phenomenon of graduate unemployment is posing a problem to countries across the globe. "Universities are not the only factor to blame. It is a complex issue that has some social, economic and cultural roots. It has more to do with the education system and its efficiency," Benahnia said. Challenges Naji said that universities face several challenges in their efforts to produce market-ready graduates. "The most important of [these challenges] is rapid developments in the global economy, especially due to artificial intelligence, which will lead to a major transformation in the field of work — [something] that universities must take into account," Naji noted.

Questions:

- (a) What does the February 2024 report by the High Commission for Planning say about job losses in Morocco? (2)
- (b) Who is Dr. Abdennasser Naji and what was his former role in the government? (2)
- (c) According to the report published by the High Commission of Planning, what were the unemployment figures among university graduates in 2023? (2)
- (d) What are Naji's recommendations to improve the unemployment situation? (2)
- (e) What, according to you, is the main idea of the passage? (2)
- (f) Explain the line, 'Universities are not the only factor to blame'. (1)
- (g) The title of the passage suggests that _____. (1)

- (h) According to Prof. Abdul Benahnia, graduate unemployment, _____ (i) is a local problem (ii) can be easily addressed by the government (iii) was a problem In the past but not anymore (iv) is an issue in many countries of the world (1)
- (i) Refined sugars are _____ into the bloodstream very quickly. (i) diluted (ii) evaporated (iii) absorbed (iv) dissolved(1)
- (j) The job advert clearly states the requisite _____ and experience for each job description. (i) characteristics (ii) features (iii) opportunities. (1)
17. (a) Write a recipe for an evening snack of your choice. (5)
- (b) Write a brief review of your favourite restaurant in Chennai. (10)

18. (a) Evaluate the documentary “The Elephant Whisperers” from your perspective. (15)

Or

- (b) What universal human values are highlighted in the story “The Last Leaf”? (15)
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